

AHMEDABAD | Title Claim



Popular belief has it that it was Rabindranath Tagore who first addressed Bapu as 'Mahatma' in July 1915. There's a twist in the tale—or at least a clarification. A document submitted to the Sabarmati Ashram by Manubhai Parekh, 96, claims it was his father Devchandra Uttamchand Parekh who first addressed Bapu as 'Shriman Mahatma Mohandas Karamchand Gandhi' on January 21, 1915. Amrut Modi, director of Sabarmati Ashram Memorial Trust says, "There's no confusion about this. But since Tagore was a bigger personality, his sentiment got more prominence."

by Jhumari Nigam-Misra

MAHATMA GANDHI GREETING A FOLLOWER

A DOCUMENT SUBMITTED TO SABARMATI ASHRAM CLAIMS THAT TAGORE WAS ACTUALLY NOT THE FIRST TO ADDRESS GANDHI AS 'MAHATMA'

DELHI | The Sting of Bad Times

Sometimes even kings of good times must combat like common men. Plagued by huge losses, full service airlines are struggling to cope in the face of low-cost competition from carriers like GoAir, IndiGo, SpiceJet. Kingfisher has gone on the front-foot with, what a senior official describes as "nasty ads". In its latest ad 'offensive', the airline touts the "respect" of flying Kingfisher against the "In-dignity" of travelling with a rival, sings about the pleasure of a "different" experience over "In-different" service. Its second parry has Kingfisher asking customers to "fly upgraded" and "fly like a guest", rather than "Go degraded" and "Go like a passenger". Ouch, never mind sticks and stones, those words sure hurt.

by Nivedita Mukherjee

BANGALORE | Grave Error

In Software City, the economic crisis has left out-of-work techies coping in different ways. Recently, a software engineer with HCL who first lost his job and was later abandoned by his wife was found performing a puja in a graveyard to ward off evil. Except that the sadhu he had employed was performing the puja in the nude. The chanting woke up the neighbours, who handed them over to the police. Both were booked for creating a 'public nuisance.' Was it a nuisance or actually a scene?

by Nirmala Ravindran

MUMBAI'S HARASSED TRAIN COMMUTERS CAN MAKE THEIR COMPLAINTS HEARD OVER SMS

MUMBAI | ON THE E-TRACK

Next time if a harassed Mumbai commuter finds cracked train seats, an SMS to Central Railway (CR) should sound the alert. In a bid to increase customer satisfaction, CR recently introduced a feedback and suggestions system through SMS and email. The brainchild of CR's General Manager B.B. Modgil, the system aims to bridge the gap between commuters and the authorities. "This will align the railway's resources and priorities with consumer expectations," says Shriniwas Mudgerikar, CR chief public relations officer. On Day One, the CR received over 200 messages ranging from gripes over punctuality and cleanliness and the need for footbridges. Launched as a trial for six months, the system aims to compile all suggestions and problems. And then get the authorities to step in and hopefully solve problems.

by Aditi Pai

BHASKAR PAUL



HANGING OUT IN A MUMBAI LOCAL? YOU CAN STILL USE OUR FREE HAND TO E-COMPLAIN